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Inventor(s)	Lent; Eric et al.

Medical imaging device

Abstract

A medical device comprising a shaft defining a first channel having a distal opening, a printed circuit board (PCB) coupled to a distal end of the shaft to expose the distal opening to an external environment, wherein the PCB includes an imager and at least one light, the imager and the at least one light mounted on a distal facing surface of the PCB, and an optically clear covering, wherein the covering covers the imager and the at least one light.

Inventors:	Lent; Eric (Roberts, WI), Rauniyar; Niraj (Plymouth, MN)
Applicant:	Boston Scientific Scimed, Inc. (Maple Grove, MN)
Family ID:	78086185
Assignee:	Boston Scientific Scimed, Inc. (Maple Grove, MN)
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Primary Examiner: Carey; Michael J

Assistant Examiner: London; Stephen Floyd

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/448,088, filed Sep. 20, 2021, which claims the benefit of priority from U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/083,151, filed on Sep. 25, 2020, each of which is incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This disclosure relates generally to an imaging device. At least some embodiments of the disclosure relate to a medical imaging device including a printed circuit board (PCB) and an overmold covering a portion of the device.

BACKGROUND

(2) Medical procedures often use an imaging device to view internal portions of the body during the procedure. For example, in an endoscopic procedure, an endoscope having lighting and an imager at a distal end may be used to view portions of the gastrointestinal tract during a procedure. Various components of medical imaging devices are often potted into a distal cap, thereby resulting in overcrowding and interference between said components. Such issues may cause the imaging devices to malfunction and exhibit various field failures. For example, plastic optical fibers, which may serve as light sources for imaging devices, may interfere with the cables of the imaging component, thereby resulting in a compromised image feed. Overcrowding may also cause wear between cables and components, which, in turn, can result in wire corrosion and damage. Thus, the aforementioned issues and resulting effects may cause significant expense to rework or replace the imaging devices.

SUMMARY OF THE DISCLOSURE

(3) According to an example, a medical device may comprise a shaft defining a first channel having a distal opening, a printed circuit board (PCB) coupled to a distal end of the shaft to expose the distal opening to an external environment, wherein the PCB includes an imager and at least one light, the imager and the at least one light mounted on a distal facing surface of the PCB, and an optically clear covering, wherein the covering covers the imager and the at least one light. The shaft may further define a second channel having a second distal opening exposed to an external environment. The covering may cover all distally-facing surfaces of the PCB.

(4) In another example, the medical device may further comprise a first cable extending through a second channel of the shaft, wherein the first cable is fixed to the PCB. The medical device may further comprise a second cable extending through a third channel of the shaft, wherein the second cable is fixed to the PCB, wherein the first cable and the second cable are configured to steer a distal portion of the medical device. The first cable and the second cable may be electrically conductive. The first cable may extend through a first cable opening of the PCB and the second cable may extend through a second cable opening of the PCB, wherein the first cable opening and the second cable opening are lined with conductive plating. The first cable and the second cable may be electrically connected to the at least one light.

(5) In another example, the at least one light may include a plurality of lights. The at least one light may include a light emitting diode (LED). The covering may not cover the distal opening of the first channel. The PCB may further include at least one capacitor mounted on a proximal facing surface of the PCB. The PCB may be semi-annular. The covering may cover at least a portion of a distally-facing surface of the shaft. The covering may define an opening in fluid communication with the distal opening of the first channel.

(6) According to another example, a medical device may comprise a shaft defining a first channel

and a second channel each extending longitudinally through the shaft and each having a distal opening exposed to an external environment, a printed circuit board (PCB) adjacent a distal end of the shaft, wherein the PCB includes an imager and a light, the imager and the light mounted on a distal facing surface of the PCB, a first cable and a second cable, wherein the first cable and the second cable extend through third and fourth channels of the shaft respectively and are fixed to the PCB, and an optically clear covering that seals the PCB from the external environment. The first channel may extend distally past the PCB, and the second channel may extend distally past the PCB. The covering may cover all distally-facing surfaces of the PCB.

(7) According to another example, a medical device may comprise a shaft, a printed circuit board (PCB) connected to a distal end of the shaft, wherein the PCB includes an imager and a light each mounted on a distal facing surface of the PCB, an optically clear covering that seals the PCB from an external environment, a first cable fixed to the PCB and configured to steer a distal portion of the shaft, and wherein the first cable is electrically conductive and provides current to at least one of the image and the light. The medical device may further comprise a second cable fixed to the PCB and configured to steer the distal portion of the shaft, wherein the PCB further includes a second light mounted on the distal facing surface of the PCB.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated in and constitute a part of this specification, illustrate various exemplary embodiments and together with the description, serve to explain the principles of the disclosed embodiments.

(2) FIG. 1A is a perspective view of a medical device, according to an embodiment.

(3) FIG. 1B is a perspective view of a medical device, according to another embodiment.

(4) FIG. 2 is a partial cross-sectional side view of a portion of the medical device of FIG. 1.

(5) FIG. 3A is a view of a distal end of the medical device of FIG. 1.

(6) FIG. 3B is a cross-sectional view of a portion of the medical device of FIG. 1, showing a proximally-facing surface of a PCB.

(7) FIG. 3C is a view of a distal end of a medical device of another embodiment.

(8) FIG. 3D is a view of a distal end of a medical device of another embodiment.

(9) FIG. 4A is a view of a distal surface of a PCB according to an embodiment.

(10) FIG. 4B is a view of a distal surface of a PCB according to another embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(11) Reference will now be made in detail to aspects of the disclosure, examples of which are illustrated in the accompanying drawings. Wherever possible, the same or similar reference numbers will be used through the drawings to refer to the same or like parts. The term “distal” refers to a portion farthest away from a user when introducing a device into a subject (e.g., a patient). By contrast, the term “proximal” refers to a portion closest to the user when placing the device into the subject.

(12) Both the foregoing general description and the following detailed description are exemplary and explanatory only and are not restrictive of the features, as claimed. As used herein, the terms “comprises,” “comprising,” “having,” “including,” or other variations thereof, are intended to cover a non-exclusive inclusion such that a process, method, article, or apparatus that comprises a list of elements does not include only those elements, but may include other elements not expressly listed or inherent to such a process, method, article, or apparatus. In this disclosure, relative terms, such as, for example, “about,” “substantially,” “generally,” and “approximately,” are used to indicate a possible variation of $\pm 10\%$ in a stated value or characteristic.

(13) Embodiments of the disclosure may solve one or more of the limitations in the art. The scope

of the disclosure, however, is defined by the attached claims and not the ability to solve a specific problem. The disclosure is drawn to a medical device including an imager, a printed circuit board (PCB) in a distal portion of the imaging device, and an overmold covering a distal portion of the medical device. The medical device can be, as an example, any imaging scope (e.g., bronchoscope, duodenoscope, endoscope, colonoscope, ureteroscope, etc.), catheter, tool, instrument, or the like, having a shaft that extends distally from a handle to a distal portion of the device. In some embodiments, the shaft may be a multi-lumen extrusion including a plurality of separate channels, e.g., for fluid, cables, and for tools in working channels. Thus, the shaft may function as a sheath for the various tubings or channels. The number of lumens of a multi-lumen extrusion is not particularly limited. The working channel, likewise, may extend distally from a handle within a lumen of said shaft. The working channel may be a channel of the multi-lumen extrusion or may be a tubing of any suitable material within a channel, and the working channel is configured to receive at least one accessory device. In some instances, the tubing may extend distally past a distal end of the shaft.

(14) The PCB is not particularly limited and may be any suitable board configured to be populated with electrical components. For example, the PCB may be any standard 1-sided or 2-sided PCB, and the PCB may be populated with components by any suitable means, e.g., Surface Mount Technology (SMT). In another example, the PCB may include Multilayer Ceramic Chip Capacitor (MLCC) characteristics, which allow capacitors or other electrical components to be embedded into the PCB. In other examples, the PCB may further include solder pads, or any other similar means, to allow wires to be soldered to the PCB. The PCB may be of any suitable shape, e.g., round, and size, e.g., 2 mm-3.4 mm in thickness, that allows the PCB to be overmolded (as further discussed below). Electrical components fixed onto one or both sides of the PCB may include any suitable imaging component, light source component, capacitor, sensor, accelerometer, probe, laser, and any other appropriate visualization, lighting, or diagnostic or therapy components.

(15) The PCB may be placed within the distal end of the shaft, positioned adjacent to the distal end of the shaft, or may be distal relative to the distal end of the shaft. The PCB may include openings and/or a shape or curvature to accommodate for, or otherwise be aligned with, the tubings, channels, or cables extending within the shaft. The openings may be of any suitable size or shape to allow for the tubings or channels of the shaft to be in alignment with or otherwise in fluid communication with, the openings. In some instances, the openings may be of any suitable size or shape to allow for the tubings or channels to extend distally past the PCB.

(16) The manner in which the PCB is fixed to the distal end of the shaft is not particularly limited. For example, an outer the surface of the shaft, e.g., the distal facing surface of the shaft, may be epoxied or tacked onto the PCB by any suitable means. Furthermore, cables, e.g., steering cables, of the device may be soldered onto a surface, e.g., the distal facing surface, of the PCB, thereby providing further securing. A fixture, e.g., molded silicone or optically clear epoxy, may also be implemented to assist this process of fixing the PCB onto the distal portion of the medical device.

(17) The overmold may cover and adhere to a distal portion of the medical device. This may include a portion of the distal tip of the device, the PCB, and a distal portion of the shaft. The material of the overmold is not particularly limited, and may be any suitable biocompatible material. For example, the overmold may be of an optically clear material or epoxy. The overmold may sufficiently adhere onto the distal portion of the medical device to withstand typical wear and friction while traversing various bodily lumens. As noted in the aforementioned examples of materials, the overmold may be an optically clear material, so that imaging components continue to provide a clear image feed through the overmold layer, and light components effectively illuminate past the layer. Furthermore, the overmold may be shaped or molded in such a manner to accommodate for an imager fixed at any angle relative to an axis of the shaft, working channel, and/or PCB.

(18) The overmold layer generally does not cover the portion of the distal facing surface of the

shaft including the one or more working and fluid channels and/or tubings. However, in certain instances, the overmold layer may further include openings at the distal tip aligned with the fluid channels and/or working channels, and allow passage of fluid or instruments therethrough. Furthermore, in some embodiments, the overmold may also include an opening for an imaging component. The overmold may be flush against the outer surfaces of the tubings and/or channels, thereby sealing the remaining distal portion of the device from the external environment. The overmold may contain the electronics and encase them to seal the electronics from saline and other fluids. Thus, the overmold may effectively seal the PCB and other electronic components from fluid ingress. The overmold, due to some flexibility in its material and structure, may also provide strain relief for the electronic components. In some embodiments, the distal facing surface of the overmold may also have a particular shape. For example, the distal facing surface may have a curved shape that allows an enhanced or focused light dispersion pattern from illumination sources on the PCB. The overmold may also function as a heat sink for the illumination sources on the PCB, conducting heat away from the distal tip of the medical device. The thickness of the overmold is not particularly limited, and may be optimized for shape, light transmission, heat sinking, manufacturability, cost, etc.

(19) The manufacturing process of the above discussed medical device is not particularly limited. The distal portion of the device includes a suitable PCB including various desired electronic components mounted onto said PCB. As noted above, the PCB may be of any suitable shape, e.g., a half-annular shape. The PCB may then be fitted onto the distal end of the shaft, e.g., MLE, via any suitable manner. For example, a PCB may be adhered or tacked onto the distal facing surface of the MLE. Prior to said tacking, the MLE may be trimmed or shaped to better accommodate for the PCB, so that the distal facing surface of the PCB and of the shaft are aligned/planar. In another example, the shaft may have lips or edges slightly extruding beyond the distal face of the shaft, and the PCB may be fitted within the lips or edges. Cables, e.g., steering cables extending within lumens of the shaft, may be fixed, e.g., soldered, onto the PCB, thereby further securing the PCB onto the medical device. After coupling the PCB onto the shaft via any suitable manner, at least the distal portion of the device may be placed or fitted within a molded fixture, e.g., a molded silicon fixture. The molded fixture may be shaped so that only a desired area for overmolding may be exposed to an injection molding of the overmold material. The overmold may be dispensed around said desired area, and afterwards, may be subjected to a series of curing and/or baking procedures to harden the overmold. In instances in which an overmold is to be applied over an entire distal face of the device, rods may be inserted within openings of channels and/or tubes. The rods may be removed after application of the overmold to form openings for the passage of instruments and/or fluid therethrough.

(20) Referring to FIG. 1A, a medical device **1**, e.g., an imaging scope, according to an embodiment is shown. Medical device **1** includes a shaft **40** (e.g., a catheter) and a handle **30** coupled to a proximal portion of shaft **40**. Handle **30** is not particularly limited, and may be any suitable imaging device handle. For example, handle **30** may include at least one aspect for actuating or controlling medical device **1** and any tools or devices associated with medical device **1**. Shaft **40** may extend from handle **30** to a distal portion **10** of medical device **1**. As discussed above, shaft **40** may be any suitable biocompatible and flexible shaft. As shown in FIG. 1, shaft **40** may be a multi-lumen extrusion including a plurality of lumens to accommodate for various separate channels or cables, e.g., an electrical cable **18**, irrigation/aspiration tubes **16**, cables **14**, and a working channel **12**.

(21) Electrical cable **18** may be any suitable cabling receiving and sheathing at least one electrical wire (not shown) from the electrical component(s) mounted onto a PCB **100** (discussed in further detail below). Thus, cable **18** may extend distally from handle **30** or an external electrical source (positive, ground, and/or negative voltage) to the electrical components, e.g., an imager **120** and light sources **140a**, **140b**, of PCB **100**. Cable **18** may be of an insulative material, and may include

at least one lumen (not shown) for receiving the at least one wire. There may be separate wires for each of imager **120**, light source **140a**, and light source **140b**.

(22) Tubes **16** may be any suitable tubing for irrigation or aspiration purposes. For example, tubes **16** may be a saline flush tube. Tubes **16** include channels **17** through which irrigation or aspiration is provided. Tubes **16** may extend distally from handle **30** or an external component, and may extend distally past PCB **100**, as shown in FIG. **1A**.

(23) Cable **14** may be any suitable cable, e.g., a Bowden cable, configured to help steer distal portion **10** of device **1**. There may be any suitable number of cables **14**, e.g., one, two, three, or four cables **14** (two are shown in FIG. **1A**). A distal end of each cable **14** may fixedly connect to PCB **100** at a corresponding opening **101**. A proximal end of each cable **14** may be fixed to an actuator of handle **30**, as is known in the art. Actuation of the actuator will push or pull cable(s) **14**, causing the distal portion of shaft **40** to articulate in a left, right, up, and/or down direction. Shaft **40** may include an articulation joint at a distal end of shaft **40** that has sufficient flexibility to bend.

(24) Furthermore, one or more of cables **14** may also be configured to draw current from an electrical source to power electrical components on the PCB, e.g., lights **140a**, **140b**, which may require a different voltage than other electrical components, e.g., imager **120**. Thus, cable **14** may be of any suitable material, and in some instances, may be of a conductive material, e.g., medical grade stainless steel. When configured to carry current, cable **14** may be a 20-50 gauge wire, but is not limited thereto. Moreover, cable **14**, when conductive, may further include an insulative sheathing around the conductive cable. As mentioned, cable **14** may extend distally from a portion of handle **30** configured to control the steering of distal portion **10** and/or an electrical source (positive, ground, and/or negative voltage), and the distal end of cable **14** may be fixed onto PCB **100** through cable opening **101** provided on PCB **100**. Each cable opening **101** may be plated with a conductive material **114** for electrical connectivity purposes. The fixing of cable **14** to cable opening **101** may be via any suitable means, e.g., soldering or fastening with electrically conductive epoxy.

(25) In FIG. **1A**, working channel **12** may be any suitable tubing with at least one lumen **13** extending from a proximal end to a distal end of channel **12**. Working channel **12** may be configured to receive at least one accessory device via lumen **13**. The size, e.g., diameter, of lumen **13** is not particularly limited, and, for example, may be about 1.20 mm-1.65 mm. Channel **12** may extend from handle **30** to a distal portion **10** of device **1**, and have an opening at its distal end.

(26) Distal portion **10** of medical device **1** includes PCB **100** and an overmold **20**. PCB **100** is semi-circular or semi-annular, and includes a distal facing surface **110a** (shown in FIGS. **1A** and **3A**) and a proximal facing surface **110b** (shown in FIG. **3B**) onto which electrical components may be mounted. PCB **100** may have a similar shape as the PCBs shown in FIGS. **4A-4B**. PCB **100** may be distal relative to shaft **40**, within a distal end of shaft **40**, or adjacent to a distal end of shaft **40**. As shown in FIG. **1A**, PCB **100** is adjacent to a distal end of shaft **40**, and is fixed to said distal end via an adhesive or epoxy. The semi-annular shape of PCB **100** has a radially-inward curved edge to accommodate for channel **12**. Moreover, PCB **100** includes a number of openings **101** for receiving cables **14**. PCB **100** is described in further detail below, when referring to FIGS. **3A-3D**.

(27) Overmold **20** is a biocompatible layer or substrate that covers a portion of distal portion **10**. Said portions include at least a portion, or all, of PCB **100**. Overmold **20** adheres onto a distal portion of shaft **40** and may cover all portions of PCB **100** and the electronic components mounted thereon (e.g., imager **120**, light sources **140a**, **140b**, and capacitors **160a**, **160b**) that are exposed to an external environment. Overmold **20** thereby serves as a seal from any fluid ingress. It is noted that, in other embodiments, overmold **20** may not extend proximally past PCB **100** to the distal portion of shaft **40**. However, such adhesion to shaft **40** may further help maintain PCB **100** adjacent against the distal end of shaft **40** and better act as a seal. Overmold **20** is optically clear to allow maximum illumination transmission from light **140a**, **140b** across wavelengths of interest. Furthermore, the distally facing portion of overmold **20** may be curved to accommodate for the

protrusions of imager **120** and light sources **140a**, **140b**. As noted above, overmold **20** may be curved or shaped to accommodate for imager **120** fixed at an angle relative to PCB **100**, and also an enhanced or focused light dispersion pattern from light sources **140a**, **140b**. It is noted that the distal openings of channel **12**, and tubes **16** are not covered by overmold **20**. FIG. 2 illustrates a side profile of distal portion **10**, and the positioning of overmold **20** around and over distal portion **10**, including overmold **20** adhering onto a distal portion of shaft **40**. Thus, overmold **20** may cover all distally facing surfaces of PCB **100**, while not covering the distal openings of channel **12** and tube **16**.

(28) Referring to FIG. 1B, another embodiment of distal portion **10'** of device **1** is shown. Like reference numerals refer to like parts. Distal portion **10'** is without separate tubes (e.g., tube **12** and tubes **16**) extending within the plurality of lumens of shaft **40**, as shown in FIG. 1A. Rather the lumens of shaft **40** define working channel **12'**, and aspiration/irrigation channels **17'**. Channel **12'** may define lumen **13'** extending from a proximal end to a distal end of channel **12'**. Thus, channel **12'** and channels **17'** may have distal openings at the distal end of shaft **40**.

(29) FIG. 3A illustrates a distal end of device **1**, including distal facing surface **110a** of PCB **100** and a distal facing surface of shaft **40**. As discussed above, cables **14** may be received by cable openings **101** (not shown) lined with conductive material **114**. Cables **14** may be soldered or epoxied onto distal surface **110a** of PCB **100**. Channel **12** and tubes **16** extend distally past PCB **100**. However, as noted above, in some embodiments, e.g., device **1'**, the lumens of shaft **40** may define a working channel and irrigation channels. Thus, in such embodiments, the distal ends of the channels are the distal end of shaft **40**. Accessory instruments may extend distally through lumen **13**, and fluid and suction may be dispensed from irrigation/aspiration channels **17** through distal openings **17a**, **17b**.

(30) As shown in FIG. 3A, distal facing surface **110a** of PCB **100** is populated with imager **120** and lights **140a**, **140b**, which are mounted onto surface **110a**. Imager **120** includes a lens **122**, a blocking layer **124**, and a casing **126**. Lens **122** is not particularly limited and may be any suitable imaging lens or lens stack. Blocking layer **124** may be a paint, an epoxy, or a similar material applied to the side surfaces of imager **120**. Layer **124** may help block light from lights **140a**, **140b** from entering imager **120** except light entering through lens **122**, and reduce haze or bright spots in the imaging feed from imager **120**. It is noted that layer **124** may be applied to any number of the side surfaces of imager **120**. Casing **126** may be any suitable housing for containing all of the components of imager **120**. In other embodiments, imager **120** may be without layer **124**, and only include casing **126**. In some other embodiments, imager **120** may be without casing **126**, and only include layer **124**, or may include layer **124** on the outside of casing **126**. In other embodiments, imager **120** may further include a cover plate (not shown) on top of the distal facing surface of lens **122**. The cover plate may be of any suitable material that does not affect image quality, e.g., glass or plastic, and may serve as a protective barrier of lens **122**. It is noted that such a cover plate may be implemented when overmold **20** (shown in FIG. 2) does not cover imager **120**, and instead includes an opening that seals around imager **120**. In other embodiments, imager **120** can include a cover, and overmold **20** can be formed over the cover.

(31) Lights **140a**, **140b** may be any suitable source of illumination, e.g., LED. The emitted light from lights **140a**, **140b** may be of any suitable wavelength, e.g., white light, infrared, etc. As shown in FIG. 3A, lights **140a**, **140b** are on opposite sides of imager **120**. However, it is noted that the arrangement or positioning of imager **120** and lights **140a**, **140b** is not particularly limited, and may be any suitable arrangement. Distal facing surface **110a** may further include other various components such as solder pads and connectors which may improve assembly and connectivity.

(32) FIG. 3B illustrates a proximal surface **110b** of PCB **100** and a portion of shaft **40**, taken as a cross-section of device **1**. Like reference numerals refer to like parts. Proximal facing surface **110b** is populated with capacitors **160a**, **160b**. Capacitors **160a**, **160b** may be any suitable capacitors, e.g., decoupling capacitors. In some embodiments, one terminal (not shown) of capacitors **160a**,

160b may provide a voltage connection to imager **120** while the other terminal (not shown) of capacitor **160a**, **160b** provides a ground connection to imager **120**. Thus, capacitors **160a**, **160b** may hold charge to help the voltage of imager **120** to stay steady, which in turn helps image quality from imager **120**. Capacitors **160a**, **160b** may be any suitable size and thickness. Capacitors **160a**, **160b** may be of a negligible thickness so that proximal surface **110b** of PCB **100** may be adjacent to a distal surface of shaft **40**. It is further noted that the arrangement or positioning of capacitors **160a**, **160b** is not particularly limited, and may be different from what is shown in FIG. 3B.

Moreover, the number of capacitors, e.g., one, two, three, etc., is not particularly limited as well. (33) Proximal facing surface **110b** is further populated with electrical cable **18**. Proximal facing surface **110b** may further include solder pads **118**, which may be fabricated as part of PCB **100**. Solder pads **118** may be soldered to various electrical wires of cable **18**, which may electrically connect to the various components, e.g., imager **120**, lights **140a**, **140b** (not shown).

(34) PCB **100** is not limited to the various electronic components, configurations, and sizes discussed above, referring to FIGS. 3A and 3B. FIGS. 3C and 3D illustrate additional PCB embodiments (**100'**, **100''**) including different components and layouts. Like reference numerals refer to like parts. As shown in FIG. 3C, PCB **100'** includes one light **140**, and further includes a second channel **18**. Second channel **18** includes a lumen **19**. The size, e.g., diameter, of lumen **19** is not particularly limited. An additional accessory instrument/device may extend distally through lumen **19**. The additional accessory device is not particularly limited, and may include, for example, a laser probe, an electrohydraulic lithotripsy (EHL) probe, a spectrometer, an electromagnetic sensor, or an ultrasound sensor. The presence of second channel **18** may allow a physician to access and use both a primary instrument, e.g., forceps or retrieval device, and the additional accessory instrument at the same time.

(35) As shown in FIG. 3D, PCB **100''** may also be without some of the electrical components discussed above. PCB **100''** is without tubes **16** and cables **14** (shown in FIGS. 3A and 3C). Thus, PCB **100''**, and shaft **40**, may be of a smaller diameter, which may be preferred by physicians in certain instances. FIGS. 3C and 3D illustrate the customizable nature of a printed circuit board (e.g., PCB **100'**, **100''**), and how the board may be tailored to suit various purposes and needs of physicians.

(36) FIGS. 4A and 4B illustrate distal facing surface **110a** of PCB **100**. Like reference numerals refer to like parts. Moreover, FIGS. 4A and 4B illustrate the electrical connection between cables **14** (now differentiated by **14a**, **14b**), when electrically conductive, and lights **140a**, **140b**. As discussed above, cables **14a**, **14b** may be soldered or epoxied onto PCB **100** through cable openings **101** (not shown), which include conductive plating **114a**, **114b**. Conductive platings **114a**, **114b** outline the circumference of the cable openings, thereby surrounding cables **14a**, **14b**. The current drawn by cables **14a**, **14b** may be received by plating **114a**, **114b**, which in turn route the current towards lights **140a**, **140b**.

(37) FIG. 4A illustrates an example of a serial PCB routing between cable **14a**, lights **140a**, **140b**, and cable **14b**. As shown, cable **14a** is connected to conductive plating **114a**, which is connected to light **140a** via a first conductive trace **141a** extending to a first connection point, e.g., a terminal, **142a**. Light **140a** also includes a second connection point **144a**. Second connection point **144a** connects to light **140b** via a second conductive trace **141b** extending to a second connection point **144b** of light **140b**. A first connection point **142b** of light **140b** is connected to conductive plating **114b** via a third conductive trace **141c**, which connects to cable **14b**. It is noted that each of the aforementioned first and second connection points **142a**, **144a**, **142b**, and **144b** of lights **140a**, **140b** are lined with a conductive plating **1140a**, **1140b** for connectivity purposes. For example, conductive plating **1140a**, **1140b** may be fabricated in PCB **100** for the aforementioned connections points of lights **140a**, **140b**. In this embodiment, plating **1140b** may serve as a voltage supply, while plating **1140a** serves as the electrical ground. For example, cable **14b** may apply 6 V to plating **1140b**, which would result in both lights **140a**, **140b** being supplied 3 V, due to the serial routing.

(38) FIG. 4B illustrates an example of a parallel PCB routing between cable **14a**, lights **140a**, **140b**, and cable **14b**. As shown, cable **14a** is connected to conductive plating **1140a**, which is connected to light **140a** via first conductive trace **141a** extending to first connection point **142a**. Light **140a** also includes second connection point **144a** and a third connection point **146a**. There is a parallel connection between light **140a** and light **140b**, as second connection point **144a** and third connection point **146a** respectively connect with second connection point **144b** and a third connection point **146b** of light **140b** via conductive traces **141b**, **141c** respectively. It is noted that each of the aforementioned first, second, and third connection points **142a**, **144a**, **146a**, **142b**, **144b**, and **146b** of lights **140a**, **140b** are lined with a conductive plating **1140a**, **1140b** for connectivity purposes. For example, conductive plating **1140a**, **1140b** may be fabricated in PCB **100** for the aforementioned connections points of lights **140a**, **140b**. In this embodiment, plating **1140b** may serve as a voltage supply, while plating **1140a** serves as the electrical ground. For example, cable **14b** may apply 3 V to plating **114b**, which would result in both lights **140a**, **140b** being supplied 3 V, due to the parallel routing.

(39) It is noted that cables **14a**, **14b** are not limited to electrically powering lights **140a**, **140b**, and may provide current to other various electric components of PCB **100**. Cables **14a**, **14b** may power two separate device voltages if provided with an additional electrical ground, or provide a single device voltage supply and ground.

(40) It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that various modifications and variations can be made to the disclosed device without departing from the scope of the disclosure. Other embodiments of the disclosure will be apparent to those skilled in the art from consideration of the specification and practice of the invention disclosed herein. It is intended that the specification and examples be considered as exemplary only, with a true scope and spirit of the invention being indicated by the following claims.

Claims

1. A medical device, comprising: a shaft having a distal facing surface at a distal end of the shaft and defining a channel having a distal opening; and a printed circuit board (PCB) coupled to the distal end of the shaft and having a concavity to expose the distal opening of the channel to an external environment, wherein the PCB includes an electrical component mounted on a distal facing surface of the PCB; wherein the distal facing surface of the shaft and the distal facing surface of the PCB are flush.
2. The medical device of claim 1, wherein the electrical component includes an imager and at least one light.
3. The medical device of claim 2, further comprising an optically clear covering, wherein the covering covers the imager and the at least one light, and wherein the covering contacts a distal facing surface of the imager and a distal facing surface of the at least one light.
4. The medical device of claim 3, wherein the optically clear covering covers at least a portion of the distal facing surface of the PCB, wherein the covering does not cover the distal opening of the channel, and wherein the covering defines an opening in fluid communication with the distal opening of the channel.
5. The medical device of claim 1, wherein the PCB further includes at least one capacitor mounted on a proximal facing surface of the PCB.
6. The medical device of claim 1, wherein the shaft further defines a second channel having a second distal opening exposed to the external environment.
7. The medical device of claim 1, wherein the medical device further comprises a first cable extending through a second channel of the shaft, wherein the first cable is fixed to the PCB.
8. The medical device of claim 7, wherein the medical device further comprises a second cable extending through a third channel of the shaft, wherein the second cable is fixed to the PCB, and

wherein the first cable and the second cable are configured to steer a distal portion of the medical device.

9. The medical device of claim 8, wherein the first cable and the second cable are electrically conductive, wherein the first cable extends to a first cable opening of the PCB and the second cable extends to a second cable opening of the PCB, wherein the first cable opening and the second cable opening are lined with conductive plating.

10. The medical device of claim 9, wherein the first cable and the second cable are electrically connected to a plurality light emitting diodes (LED).

11. A medical device, comprising: a shaft having a distal facing surface at a distal end of the shaft, the shaft further defining a channel extending longitudinally through the shaft and having a distal opening exposed to an external environment; a printed circuit board (PCB) adjacent the distal end of the shaft, wherein the PCB includes an electrical component mounted on a distal facing surface of the PCB; and a cable, wherein the cable extends through the channel of the shaft and is fixed to the PCB; wherein the distal facing surface of the shaft and the distal facing surface of the PCB are flush.

12. The medical device of claim 11, wherein the channel is a first channel, and wherein a second channel extends longitudinally through the shaft and has a distal opening exposed to the external environment.

13. The medical device of claim 12, wherein the cable is a first cable and the medical device further comprises a second cable, wherein the first cable and the second cable extend through the first and the second channels of the shaft respectively and are fixed to the PCB.

14. A medical device, comprising: a shaft having a distal facing surface at a distal end of the shaft; a printed circuit board (PCB) connected to the distal end of the shaft, wherein a distal facing surface of the PCB and the distal facing surface of the shaft are flush; and a cable fixed to the distal facing surface of the PCB and configured to steer a distal portion of the shaft, wherein the cable is electrically conductive.

15. The medical device of claim 14, wherein a proximal end of the cable is fixed to a steering actuator.

16. The medical device of claim 15, wherein the cable extends through an opening on the distal facing surface of the PCB and is electrically coupled to the distal facing surface of the PCB.

17. The medical device of claim 16, wherein the PCB includes a light mounted on the distal facing surface of the PCB.

18. The medical device of claim 17, wherein the opening is surrounded by conductive plating, and wherein the cable is electrically coupled to the conductive plating.

19. The medical device of claim 18, wherein the conductive plating is electrically connected to a conductive trace, which is electrically connected to the light.

20. The medical device of claim 19, wherein the cable is a first cable, wherein the opening is a first opening, the conductive plating is a first conductive plating, wherein the medical device further comprises a second cable that extends through a second opening of the PCB, wherein the second cable is electrically coupled to a second conductive plating surrounding the second opening on the distal facing surface of the PCB, wherein the first conductive plating serves as a voltage supply, and wherein the second conductive plating serves as a ground.
